British authorities were rewarded with the results that could be expected—Arab riots and a pogrom which broke out in Hebron in 1929. The 1936–1939 Arab revolt caused havoc. Hundreds of Jews were killed, and a widespread atmosphere of antisemitic hatred developed. Then came to abandonment of the European Jews by every Western country at the Evian Conference in July 1938. Before the conference, Hitler had said that if other countries would agree to take the Jews he would help them to leave. But when the United States and Britain refused to accept Jewish refugees, other countries at the conference followed suit, and any mention of the British Mandate of "Palestine" as a possible destination for Jewish refugees was deliberately excluded from the agenda. The decision-making process which led to the "Final Solution to the Jewish Problem" began immediately after the Evian Conference and was a direct result of it.

Despite the Holocaust, the murder of six million Jews trapped in Europe, and the complicity of some Western powers with the enemies of Israel to destroy the Jewish State the day it was established, the Zionists won the War of Independence. Although most Western countries had voted in favor of the Partition Plan, none actually helped the newborn state. Only one country (and not a powerful one) provided weapons: Communist Czechoslovakia. On the other hand, the Arab armies that attacked Israel on the day of its birth were equipped and supplied by the British and the French. Most Western leaders did not think Israel would last long. All of them were sure that Arab armies would win and wipe out both Israel and much of its Jewish population.

In the 1950s, Israel had almost no allies. During the 1956 Suez war, the British and French had temporarily signed alliances and cooperation agreements with Israel—for opportunistic reasons. The British and French sought to preserve their colonial and economic interests against Soviet-allied Arab nationalists. But the United States, apparently wanting to have good relations with Turkey and fundamentalist Saudi Arabia, preferred appeasement. President Eisenhower did not support the action of France, Britain, and Israel against the nationalization of the Suez Canal in 1956; instead, he granted a political victory to Egypt's President, Gamal Abdel Nasser.[14] The British and French were humiliated while Israel was forced to withdraw from Sinai.

During the 1960s, the French—after the Algerian War of Independence, which ended in March 1962—switched sides again. This period was the beginning of the so-called "Arab policy of France," which later became the Arab and Muslim policy of Europe. President De Gaulle openly turned his back on Israel in 1967. The British also switched sides again, strengthening

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